

Word family: **radio / radios / radioed / radioing / radio broadcasting / radio communication**

Base word: radio

Plural: radios

Past tense: radioed

Past participle: radioed

** -ing form:** radioing

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-like modifier (名詞作前置修飾) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “Mr. Wong, who is a retired **radio journalist** in his late sixties.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **radio** refers to **the broadcasting medium in which programmes, news, interviews, music, etc. are transmitted by radio waves for listeners**.

A **radio journalist** is therefore a journalist whose work is produced primarily for **radio broadcasting**, rather than newspapers, television, or another medium.

繁體中文： **透過無線電波向聽眾播送新聞、訪問、音樂及其他節目的廣播媒體**

中文翻譯：

> “...Mr. Wong, who is a retired **radio journalist** ...”

「.....黃先生是一位已退休的**電台 / 廣播新聞記者**.....」

Here:

radio journalist = 主要為電台廣播製作、報道或主持新聞內容的記者

1. **radio** = broadcasting medium/service (廣播媒體 / 電台廣播) — 電台廣播；無線電廣播

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The system or medium of broadcasting speech, music, news, entertainment, etc. to the public using radio waves.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Mr. Wong is a retired **radio journalist**.”

「黃先生是一位已退休的**電台新聞記者 / 廣播記者**。」

Practice 2

> “She began her career in **radio** before moving into television.”

「她的職業生涯最初是在**電台廣播業**開始的，後來才轉到電視界。」

Practice 3

> “The interview was broadcast live on **radio**.”

「這個訪問透過**電台廣播**現場播放。」

****radio = 以無線電波向公眾傳送聲音節目、新聞、音樂及其他內容的廣播媒體****

Common expressions:

- * radio station
- * radio programme
- * radio presenter
- * radio journalist
- * radio interview
- * radio broadcasting

These are normally the same underlying ****broadcast-media**** sense, not separate meanings.

2. ****a radio = device for receiving broadcasts (接收廣播的器材) — 收音機****

Here, ****radio**** means the ****physical electronic device****.

Practice 4

> “There was an old ****radio**** on the kitchen shelf.”

「廚房架子上放着一部舊****收音機****。」

Practice 5

> “He turned on the ****radio**** to listen to the news.”

「他打開****收音機****收聽新聞。」

****a radio = 用來接收及播放無線電廣播訊號的電子設備****

This is different from Meaning 1:

> **radio is popular**

> = 電台廣播這種媒體很受歡迎

versus

> **I bought a radio**

> = 我買了一部收音機

The first is a **medium**; the second is a **physical object**.

3. **radio = wireless communication system (無線電通訊) — 無線電 ; 無線通訊**

Here, **radio** is not primarily public broadcasting.

It means communication between people, vehicles, ships, aircraft, emergency services, military units, etc. using radio signals.

Practice 6

> “The pilots remained in contact by **radio**.”

「機師一直透過**無線電通訊**保持聯絡。」

Practice 7

> “The rescue team communicated with the base by **radio**.”

「救援隊透過**無線電**與基地保持通訊。」

radio = 利用無線電訊號在不同地點之間傳送語音或其他資訊的通訊方式

Compare:

> “I heard the news on **radio**.”

= 透過廣播媒體收聽新聞

but:

> “The pilot contacted the tower by **radio**.”

= 利用無線電通訊與塔台聯絡

These require different mental concepts and should remain separate.

4. **radio = radio-wave technology/signals (無線電波 / 無線電技術) — 無線電的 ; 利用無線電波的**

In compounds and technical descriptions, **radio** can refer more broadly to **electromagnetic radio waves and technology based on them**.

Practice 8

> “The telescope detects **radio signals** from space.”

「這部望遠鏡可以偵測來自太空的**無線電訊號**。」

Practice 9

> “Scientists use **radio waves** to study distant objects in space.”

「科學家利用**無線電波**研究太空中的遙遠天體。」

****radio + noun = 與無線電波、無線電訊號或利用這些訊號的技術有關****

Common examples:

- * radio waves
- * radio signal
- * radio frequency
- * radio telescope
- * radio astronomy
- * radio transmitter

This overlaps historically with radio communication, but for learners the **physical signal/technology** concept is distinct enough from either a broadcasting medium or a receiver.

5. **radio + person/place = contact or send a message by radio (以無線電聯絡) — 用無線電呼叫 / 傳訊**

****Radio** can also be a **verb**.**

****Meaning:**** To communicate with someone or send information using radio equipment.

Practice 10

> “The captain **radioed** the coastguard for help.”

「船長透過**無線電聯絡**海岸防衛隊求助。」

Practice 11

> “The pilot **radioed** the control tower before landing.”

「機師降落前用**無線電聯絡**控制塔。」

radio someone / radio a message = 利用無線電設備與某人聯絡或傳送訊息

Notice the grammatical change:

> **radio** — noun

> “They communicated by **radio**.”

> **radio** — verb

> “They **radioed** for help.”

The Golden Manual specifically says that the same spelling functioning as different parts of speech with different concepts should be separated when useful.

Important distinction: **radio** = medium vs a **radio** = device

This is probably the most important learner contrast.

radio — medium

Usually uncountable:

> “He works in **radio**.”

「他從事**電台廣播工作**。」

a radio — device

Countable:

> “He bought a new **radio**.”

「他買了一部新的**收音機**。」

So:

****radio = 廣播媒體****

****a radio = 接收廣播的實體設備****

Important distinction: ****radio broadcasting vs radio communication****

****radio broadcasting****

One source sends programmes to a large public audience.

Examples:

- * radio news
- * music programmes
- * interviews
- * talk shows

****radio communication****

People or organizations communicate directly over radio.

Examples:

- * pilots ↔ control tower
- * ship ↔ coastguard
- * police officers ↔ control room

So:

****broadcasting radio = 向大量聽眾播送節目****

****radio communication = 在特定通訊雙方之間利用無線電傳送資訊****

Important distinction: ****radio vs television****

Both are broadcast media, but the sensory format differs.

****radio****

primarily transmits **sound**

television

transmits **moving images together with sound**

Therefore:

> **radio journalist**

usually produces journalism intended primarily to be **heard**

whereas:

> **television journalist**

works in an audiovisual medium.

Important distinction: **radio vs podcast**

These may both contain spoken audio, but traditionally:

radio

content is transmitted through a broadcasting system, often according to a programme schedule.

podcast

audio content is normally distributed digitally and accessed on demand.

Modern radio programmes may also be released as podcasts, so the categories can overlap in distribution, but the terms are not identical.

Countability note

This word changes meaning partly through countability.

Uncountable

> "I heard it on **radio**."

= through the broadcasting medium

Countable

> “There are three **radios** in the house.”

= three physical receiver devices

This is exactly the kind of distinction the Golden Manual treats as useful when countability changes how a word is understood.

Family-extension note

The practical family is relatively compact:

- * **radio** *
- * **radios** *
- * **radioed** *
- * **radioing** *
- * **radio broadcasting** *
- * **radio communication** *
- * **radio wave** *
- * **radio signal** *
- * **radio frequency** *
- * **radio telescope** *
- * **radio astronomy** *

I would **not** automatically include words such as **radiation, radioactive,** or **radiology** in this entry**.**

They are historically and morphologically connected through **radi-/radio-**, but in modern learner vocabulary they function as distinct lexical families with substantially different meanings. Including them here would blur the target rather than improve polysemy discrimination.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
----- -----	
radio — broadcasting medium	透過無線電波向公眾播送新聞、音樂、訪問及其他聲音節目的廣播媒體
a radio — receiver	用來接收及播放無線電廣播訊號的實體電子設備；收音機
radio — communication	利用無線電訊號在不同地點或人員之間傳送語音或資訊的通訊方

式 |
| ****radio — waves/technology**** | 與無線電波、無線電訊號及利用它們運作的技術有關 |
| ****radio — verb**** | 使用無線電設備與某人聯絡或傳送訊息 |

For your original sentence

> “Mr. Wong, who is a retired ****radio journalist**** in his late sixties.”

The exact meaning is:

****radio = 透過無線電廣播向公眾傳送新聞、訪問及其他聲音內容的媒體****

Therefore:

****radio journalist = 主要從事電台廣播新聞採訪、報道或製作工作的記者****

For the database, I would count ****5 useful polysemy/polyfunctionality meanings**** for ****radio****:

1. ****broadcasting medium****
2. ****physical receiving device****
3. ****wireless communication****
4. ****radio-wave technology/signals****
5. ****verb — communicate by radio****